



Banking Prompt Engineering

17 Techniques - Participant Copy-Paste Toolkit

34 practical examples

Two examples for every technique

Complete input included

No missing [BEFORE] data

Ready to copy and paste

Clear instructions and safe sample data

Banking focused

Complaints, KYC, fraud, reports, policy Q&A

Use only sample or approved data. Verify important outputs before use.



How to Use This Participant Toolkit

Each technique has two practical examples with complete sample inputs.

1

Read the technique

Understand what the method changes and when it is useful.

2

Compare BEFORE and COPY-PASTE

The BEFORE prompt includes the same input, but lacks useful guidance.

3

Copy the green prompt

Paste it into your approved AI tool and replace the sample input.

Important banking safety rule

Never paste real customer names, full account numbers, passwords, PINs, OTPs, card details, or confidential bank information into an unapproved AI tool.



1. Zero-Shot Prompting

Ask the AI to complete a task directly, without showing an example.

Best used when: Use for simple, familiar tasks such as summaries, explanations, and first drafts.

Quick task

No example

First draft

Summarize a transaction complaint

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Summarize this complaint.

INPUT:

Customer says RM 2,500 was debited from mobile banking, but the beneficiary did not receive the money. The transaction was made yesterday at 3:15 PM and still shows as pending.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask the AI to complete a task directly, without showing an example.

Why this example is better:

The task, audience, format, and limits are clear.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Summarize the banking complaint below in exactly 5 bullets:

1. Issue
2. Customer impact
3. Urgency
4. Missing information
5. Recommended next action

Use simple language for a branch associate. Do not assume facts that are not provided.

INPUT:

Customer says RM 2,500 was debited from mobile banking, but the beneficiary did not receive the money. The transaction was made yesterday at 3:15 PM and still shows as pending.

Banking use: Complaint summaries, quick explanations, basic email drafts.



1. Zero-Shot Prompting

Ask the AI to complete a task directly, without showing an example.

Best used when: Use for simple, familiar tasks such as summaries, explanations, and first drafts.

Quick task

No example

First draft

Explain AI in banking

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Explain AI in banking.

INPUT:

Audience: Branch staff with no technical background.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask the AI to complete a task directly, without showing an example.

Why this example is better:

It defines the audience, structure, length, and language level.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Explain generative AI in banking operations to branch staff with no technical background.

Use:

- A simple definition
- 3 everyday banking examples
- 1 benefit
- 1 risk
- A final one-sentence takeaway

Keep the explanation under 180 words and avoid technical jargon.

INPUT:

The audience works in customer service and branch operations.

Banking use: Complaint summaries, quick explanations, basic email drafts.



2. Few-Shot Prompting

Show two or more examples so the AI copies the same pattern.

Best used when: Use when labels, tone, or output format must remain consistent.

Examples

Pattern

Consistency

Classify a complaint

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Classify this complaint.

INPUT:

EMI was deducted twice this month.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Show two or more examples so the AI copies the same pattern.

Why this example is better:

The examples teach the exact labels and output format.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Classify the new complaint using the same format as the examples.

Example 1:

Input: ATM cash was not dispensed, but the account was debited.

Output: Category: ATM Issue | Urgency: High

Example 2:

Input: I cannot log in to mobile banking.

Output: Category: Digital Banking | Urgency: Medium

Now classify:

Input: EMI was deducted twice this month.

Output only:

Category: <category> | Urgency: <Low/Medium/High>

Banking use: Complaint classification, sentiment tagging, issue routing.



2. Few-Shot Prompting

Show two or more examples so the AI copies the same pattern.

Best used when: Use when labels, tone, or output format must remain consistent.

Examples

Pattern

Consistency

Tag customer sentiment

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Find the sentiment.

INPUT:

My money is debited and nobody is helping.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Show two or more examples so the AI copies the same pattern.

Why this example is better:
Several examples establish the decision pattern.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Classify the sentiment as Positive, Neutral, or Negative.

Examples:

'I am happy with the quick service.' -> Positive

'Please check my pending request.' -> Neutral

'I called three times and received no update.' -> Negative

Now classify:

'My money is debited and nobody is helping.'

Return only one label: Positive, Neutral, or Negative.

Banking use: Complaint classification, sentiment tagging, issue routing.



3. Role Prompting

Assign the AI a specific job role or expert viewpoint.

Best used when: Use when the response needs domain-specific focus, tone, or review criteria.

Expert role

Perspective

Domain focus

Compliance review of an email

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Review this message.

INPUT:

'Your refund will definitely be credited today. Please send your full account number and ID card image by email.'

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Assign the AI a specific job role or expert viewpoint.

Why this example is better:

The role activates the correct review perspective and criteria.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Act as a banking compliance reviewer.

Review the customer email draft below for:

- Privacy risk
- Unsupported promise
- Policy or process gap
- Tone issue

First list the issues in a table:

Issue | Why it is risky | Safer approach

Then provide a safer rewritten email. Do not request sensitive information through an insecure channel.

INPUT:

'Your refund will definitely be credited today. Please send your full account number and ID card image by email.'

Banking use: Compliance review, branch operations, customer support drafting.



3. Role Prompting

Assign the AI a specific job role or expert viewpoint.

Best used when: Use when the response needs domain-specific focus, tone, or review criteria.

Expert role

Perspective

Domain focus

Branch operations review

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Assign the AI a specific job role or expert viewpoint.

Why this example is better:
The role guides the AI to think like an operations manager.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Act as a branch operations manager.

Review the daily MIS data below and provide:

1. Operational highlights
2. Customer impact
3. Risks or exceptions
4. Actions for tomorrow
5. Items requiring manager approval

Use short bullets and do not invent missing causes.

INPUT:

Queue time: 28 minutes
Failed transactions: 14
Customer complaints: 9
Cash shortage: None
System downtime: 35 minutes

Banking use: Compliance review, branch operations, customer support drafting.



4. Style Prompting

Tell the AI how the writing should sound and look.

Best used when: Use for formal, simple, empathetic, executive, SMS, or policy-style communication.

Tone

Writing style

Audience

Empathetic customer reply

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Write a reply to the customer.

INPUT:

'My ATM withdrawal failed, but RM 800 was debited. This is unacceptable.'

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Tell the AI how the writing should sound and look.

Why this example is better:

The desired tone and communication boundaries are explicit.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Rewrite a response to the customer in a polite, empathetic, and professional banking tone.

Requirements:

- Acknowledge the concern
- Do not blame the customer
- Do not promise a refund before verification
- Explain the next step
- Keep it under 120 words

INPUT:

'My ATM withdrawal failed, but RM 800 was debited. This is unacceptable.'

Banking use: Customer emails, branch notices, executive summaries.



4. Style Prompting

Tell the AI how the writing should sound and look.

Best used when: Use for formal, simple, empathetic, executive, SMS, or policy-style communication.

Tone

Writing style

Audience

Executive branch summary

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Summarize branch performance.

INPUT:

Transactions increased 12%.
Complaints increased from 5 to 11.
Average wait time increased to 24 minutes.
Two system outages occurred.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Tell the AI how the writing should sound and look.

Why this example is better:

The audience and executive writing style are clearly defined.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Write an executive-style summary for senior management.

Style:

- Formal and concise
- Short paragraphs
- Focus on risks, exceptions, and decisions needed
- Maximum 140 words

INPUT:

Transactions increased 12%.
Complaints increased from 5 to 11.
Average wait time increased to 24 minutes.
Two system outages occurred.

Banking use: Customer emails, branch notices, executive summaries.



5. Emotion Prompting

Specify the emotional quality of the response while keeping facts unchanged.

Best used when: Use for difficult conversations where trust, reassurance, and sensitivity matter.

Empathy

Trust

Sensitivity

Customer asked to wait

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Tell the customer to wait.

INPUT:

ATM withdrawal failed, but RM 500 was debited. Verification may take up to 5 working days.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Specify the emotional quality of the response while keeping facts unchanged.

Why this example is better:

It controls the emotional tone without changing the facts.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Draft a calm and empathetic response to the customer.

Include:

- Recognition of the customer's worry
- A sincere apology for the inconvenience
- A clear explanation that verification is required
- The expected verification period of up to 5 working days
- A helpful closing

Do not blame the customer or guarantee the outcome.

INPUT:

ATM withdrawal failed, but RM 500 was debited.

Banking use: Delayed cases, complaint handling, request rejection.



5. Emotion Prompting

Specify the emotional quality of the response while keeping facts unchanged.

Best used when: Use for difficult conversations where trust, reassurance, and sensitivity matter.

Empathy

Trust

Sensitivity

KYC request cannot proceed

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Reject the request.

INPUT:

The customer's address proof is expired, so account opening cannot continue.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Specify the emotional quality of the response while keeping facts unchanged.

Why this example is better:

It turns a negative message into a respectful, solution-focused response.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Politely inform the customer that account opening cannot continue until a valid address proof is provided.

Tone:

- Respectful
- Calm
- Helpful
- Non-judgmental

Also list two acceptable next steps. Keep the message under 100 words.

INPUT:

The customer's submitted address proof has expired.

Banking use: Delayed cases, complaint handling, request rejection.



6. Contextual Prompting

Provide relevant background so the AI does not guess or give a generic answer.

Best used when: Use when history, status, customer type, channel, or constraints affect the response.

Background

Case details

Accuracy

Pending transfer complaint

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Suggest action for this complaint.

INPUT:

RM 2,500 transfer is pending.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Provide relevant background so the AI does not guess or give a generic answer.

Why this example is better:

The context makes the recommendation specific and safer.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Use the case context below to recommend the next action.

Provide:

1. Immediate internal action
2. Customer update message
3. Escalation note
4. Missing information to collect

Do not state that the transaction failed unless verified.

CONTEXT:

- Complaint raised 3 days ago
- Amount: RM 2,500
- Channel: Mobile banking
- Status: Pending verification
- Beneficiary has not received funds

Banking use: Complaint history, priority customers, case escalation.



6. Contextual Prompting

Provide relevant background so the AI does not guess or give a generic answer.

Best used when: Use when history, status, customer type, channel, or constraints affect the response.

Background

Case details

Accuracy

Priority customer duplicate EMI

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Summarize this customer issue.

INPUT:
Duplicate EMI debit.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Provide relevant background so the AI does not guess or give a generic answer.

Why this example is better:
Important case history and constraints are included.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Prepare a case summary for escalation.

CONTEXT:

- Customer segment: Priority banking
- Issue: EMI was deducted twice
- A previous complaint exists
- Refund status is not confirmed
- Customer called again today

Output:

- Case summary
- Customer impact
- Missing details
- Recommended escalation
- Draft customer update

Do not promise a refund.

Banking use: Complaint history, priority customers, case escalation.



7. Step-by-Step Prompting

Give the AI a visible checklist or sequence to follow.

Best used when: Use when several checks must be completed and nothing important should be missed.

Checklist

Sequence

Completeness

Fraud alert review

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Analyze this fraud alert.

INPUT:

RM 4,800 online purchase from a new device at 2:10 AM.
Customer usually spends below RM 500.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Give the AI a visible checklist or sequence to follow.

Why this example is better:

A fixed checklist improves completeness and control.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Review the fraud alert using this checklist:

1. Alert type
2. Unusual indicators
3. Customer impact
4. Evidence to verify
5. Immediate control action
6. Escalation need
7. Final human decision required

Use only the information provided. Mark unknown items as 'Not provided'.

INPUT:

RM 4,800 online purchase from a new device at 2:10 AM. Customer usually spends below RM 500.

Banking use: Fraud alerts, KYC checks, failed transaction reviews.



7. Step-by-Step Prompting

Give the AI a visible checklist or sequence to follow.

Best used when: Use when several checks must be completed and nothing important should be missed.

Checklist

Sequence

Completeness

KYC case review

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Check this KYC case.

INPUT:

Passport valid. Utility bill expired. Name differs slightly between documents.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Give the AI a visible checklist or sequence to follow.

Why this example is better:

The sequence separates verification from the final human decision.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Review the KYC case step by step:

1. Identity proof
2. Address proof
3. Name match
4. Risk indicators
5. Missing or invalid documents
6. Clarification required
7. Maker-checker review needed
8. Human decision required

Do not approve or reject the case.

INPUT:

Passport: Valid

Utility bill: Expired

Name: 'A. Rahman' on passport and 'Abdul Rahman' on utility bill

Banking use: Fraud alerts, KYC checks, failed transaction reviews.



8. System Prompting

Set standing rules that apply to every response in the task or conversation.

Best used when: Use for repeated tasks requiring the same safety, privacy, or quality rules.

Guardrails

Standing rules

Safety

Safe complaint assistant

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Summarize complaints.

INPUT:

Customer name: Sample Customer

Account: 123456789

Complaint: Card payment duplicated.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Set standing rules that apply to every response in the task or conversation.

Why this example is better:

The safety rules remain active across the entire task.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

SYSTEM RULES:

- Use sample data only.
- Never repeat full customer identifiers.
- Mask account numbers except the last 4 digits.
- If information is missing, write 'Not provided'.
- Mark recommendations that require human approval.
- Do not claim that an issue is resolved without evidence.

TASK:

Summarize the complaint into Issue, Impact, Status, Missing Information, and Next Action.

INPUT:

Customer name: Sample Customer

Account: 123456789

Complaint: Card payment duplicated.

Banking use: Document Q&A, training assistants, repeated complaint analysis.



8. System Prompting

Set standing rules that apply to every response in the task or conversation.

Best used when: Use for repeated tasks requiring the same safety, privacy, or quality rules.

Guardrails

Standing rules

Safety

Policy-only Q&A

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Answer from the policy.

INPUT:

Can a branch associate send an account statement through personal email?

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Set standing rules that apply to every response in the task or conversation.

Why this example is better:

The rules restrict the answer to an approved source.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

SYSTEM RULES:

- Answer only from the uploaded policy document.
- Quote or cite the relevant section when available.
- If the answer is not found, say: 'Not available in the provided document.'
- Do not guess or use outside knowledge.
- Mention any required human approval.

QUESTION:

Can a branch associate send an account statement through personal email?

Banking use: Document Q&A, training assistants, repeated complaint analysis.



9. Explicit Instructions

State the exact output format, length, fields, and restrictions.

Best used when: Use when you need predictable output that can be copied into a report or system.

Clear format

Limits

No ambiguity

Failed payment summary

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Write about failed payments.

INPUT:

23 failures on mobile banking. Main period: 10:00-11:00 AM. 8 complaints received.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

State the exact output format, length, fields, and restrictions.

Why this example is better:

The AI knows exactly what to include and what to avoid.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Create exactly 6 bullets:

1. Issue summary
2. Affected channel
3. Time period
4. Customer impact
5. Recommended next action
6. Human review needed

Rules:

- Maximum 100 words
- Use only the data provided
- Do not include an introduction

INPUT:

23 failures on mobile banking.
Main period: 10:00-11:00 AM.
8 customer complaints received.

Banking use: Reports, checklists, handover notes, audit summaries.



9. Explicit Instructions

State the exact output format, length, fields, and restrictions.

Best used when: Use when you need predictable output that can be copied into a report or system.

Clear format

Limits

No ambiguity

MIS report table

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Summarize this report.

INPUT:

Wait time 24 min; complaints 11; failed transactions 14.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

State the exact output format, length, fields, and restrictions.

Why this example is better:

The strict format makes the output ready to reuse.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Output only a markdown table with these columns:
Metric | Observation | Risk | Recommended Action

Rules:

- One row per metric
- No paragraphs before or after the table
- Use only the supplied data
- Write 'Not provided' where evidence is missing

INPUT:

Average wait time: 24 minutes

Customer complaints: 11

Failed transactions: 14

Banking use: Reports, checklists, handover notes, audit summaries.



10. Output Priming

Start the response structure and ask the AI to complete it.

Best used when: Use for forms, templates, standard reports, and consistent case notes.

Template

Structure

Form output

Complaint case template

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

What should I do?

INPUT:

Customer reports a duplicate debit of RM 350.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Start the response structure and ask the AI to complete it.

Why this example is better:

The model continues from the exact structure you provide.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Complete the template using the complaint details.

Issue Summary:

Category:

Amount:

Customer Impact:

Urgency:

Missing Information:

Recommended Next Action:

Human Review Required:

Rules:

- Keep each field to one or two sentences
- Do not assume a refund
- Use 'Not provided' where needed

INPUT:

Customer reports a duplicate debit of RM 350 after using a debit card at a supermarket.

Banking use: Case notes, branch reports, complaint forms.



10. Output Priming

Start the response structure and ask the AI to complete it.

Best used when: Use for forms, templates, standard reports, and consistent case notes.

Template

Structure

Form output

Branch daily report

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Create a branch report.

INPUT:

Queue 22 min; 12 complaints; no cash shortage; 20 min downtime.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Start the response structure and ask the AI to complete it.

Why this example is better:

Priming ensures the same headings are used every time.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Complete the branch report using this structure:

Executive Summary:
Top 3 Exceptions:
Customer Impact:
Operational Risk:
Action Required:
Manager Approval Needed:

INPUT:

Average queue time: 22 minutes
Complaints: 12
Cash shortage: None
System downtime: 20 minutes

Banking use: Case notes, branch reports, complaint forms.



11. Rephrase and Respond

Ask the AI to restate its understanding before answering.

Best used when: Use when the request is unclear or a misunderstanding could create risk.

Clarify

Confirm

High-stakes

Unclear customer message

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Reply to this customer.

INPUT:

'It happened again. Please fix it immediately.'

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask the AI to restate its understanding before answering.

Why this example is better:

Restating the issue exposes uncertainty before a response is drafted.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

First rephrase what you understand from the customer's message in one sentence.

Then:

1. List the information needed to understand the issue
2. Draft a polite response asking only for non-sensitive details
3. Do not claim the issue is resolved

INPUT:

'It happened again. Please fix it immediately.'

Banking use: Ambiguous complaints, unclear customer requests, escalation notes.



11. Rephrase and Respond

Ask the AI to restate its understanding before answering.

Best used when: Use when the request is unclear or a misunderstanding could create risk.

Clarify

Confirm

High-stakes

Complaint resolution request

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Resolve this complaint.

INPUT:

'My card is not working since yesterday.'

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask the AI to restate its understanding before answering.

Why this example is better:

It confirms understanding and prevents unsafe assumptions.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

First restate what the complaint appears to be.

Then provide:

- Missing details
- Safe troubleshooting questions
- Recommended internal action
- Draft customer response

Do not state that the complaint is resolved or request a PIN, password, or OTP.

INPUT:

'My card is not working since yesterday.'

Banking use: Ambiguous complaints, unclear customer requests, escalation notes.



12. Step-Back Prompting

Ask for the broader principle first, then apply it to the specific case.

Best used when: Use for privacy, policy, risk, and responsible-AI questions.

Principle first

Policy

Risk

Sharing PAN on WhatsApp

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Can we send PAN on WhatsApp?

INPUT:

A customer asked a branch associate to send a PAN copy on WhatsApp.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask for the broader principle first, then apply it to the specific case.

Why this example is better:

The general principle leads to a more consistent and responsible answer.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

First explain the general banking data privacy principle for handling customer identifiers.

Then answer the specific question:

Should a PAN copy or account details be sent through personal WhatsApp?

Finally provide:

- The safer approved alternative
- What the associate should verify in the bank's policy
- Any required human approval

Do not invent a policy clause.

Banking use: Privacy decisions, policy interpretation, loan support.



12. Step-Back Prompting

Ask for the broader principle first, then apply it to the specific case.

Best used when: Use for privacy, policy, risk, and responsible-AI questions.

Principle first

Policy

Risk

AI-supported loan review

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Should we approve this loan?

INPUT:

Applicant income RM 6,000; requested loan RM 80,000; credit history not provided.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask for the broader principle first, then apply it to the specific case.

Why this example is better:

It prevents a premature decision by starting with the governing principle.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

First explain the general principle of responsible AI in loan decision support.

Then review the case only as decision support and list:

1. Information available
2. Important missing information
3. Checks a human loan officer must perform
4. Risks of making a decision now

Do not approve or reject the loan.

INPUT:

Monthly income: RM 6,000

Requested loan: RM 80,000

Credit history: Not provided

Banking use: Privacy decisions, policy interpretation, loan support.



13. Self-Critique & Refinement

Ask the AI to draft, check its work against criteria, and improve it.

Best used when: Use for important communication where the first draft may contain gaps or risky wording.

Draft

Review

Improve

Customer response quality check

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Draft a customer response.

INPUT:

Refund request is under investigation.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask the AI to draft, check its work against criteria, and improve it.

Why this example is better:

The model performs a second quality-control pass before finalizing.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Create a first draft response to the customer.

Then review the draft for:

- Privacy risk
- Unsupported promise
- Unclear next action
- Tone
- Compliance concern

Finally provide:

1. Issues found
2. Improved final response

INPUT:

The customer requested a refund for a duplicate card debit. Investigation is still in progress.
No completion date is confirmed.

Banking use: Customer communication, compliance-sensitive summaries.



13. Self-Critique & Refinement

Ask the AI to draft, check its work against criteria, and improve it.

Best used when: Use for important communication where the first draft may contain gaps or risky wording.

Draft

Review

Improve

Fraud summary refinement

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Create a fraud summary.

INPUT:

New device; RM 7,200 transfer; unusual time.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask the AI to draft, check its work against criteria, and improve it.

Why this example is better:

The critique step reduces assumptions and overconfident wording.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Create a fraud alert summary.

Then critique it for:

- Missing evidence
- Assumptions
- Unclear risk language
- Overconfident conclusions
- Missing human-control step

Provide a safer final version.

INPUT:

A RM 7,200 transfer was initiated from a new device at 1:45 AM. Customer confirmation has not yet been obtained.

Banking use: Customer communication, compliance-sensitive summaries.



14. Goal Decomposition

Break a large task into smaller, manageable stages.

Best used when: Use for workflows, SOPs, training plans, and multi-step business tasks.

Break down

Workflow

Stages

Complaint handling workflow

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Create a complaint process.

INPUT:

Process is for failed mobile banking transfers.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Break a large task into smaller, manageable stages.

Why this example is better:

A large request becomes a clear sequence of manageable deliverables.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Build a complaint-handling workflow for failed mobile banking transfers.

Break it into these stages:

1. Intake
2. Classification
3. Verification
4. Customer communication
5. Escalation
6. Resolution recommendation
7. Human approval
8. Closure
9. Audit record

For each stage include:

Owner | Input | Action | Output | Control

Banking use: Complaint workflows, KYC processes, SOP creation.



14. Goal Decomposition

Break a large task into smaller, manageable stages.

Best used when: Use for workflows, SOPs, training plans, and multi-step business tasks.

Break down

Workflow

Stages

KYC workflow

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Make a KYC workflow.

INPUT:

Workflow is for new individual accounts.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Break a large task into smaller, manageable stages.

Why this example is better:

Decomposition produces a complete and usable process map.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Design a KYC review workflow for new individual customer accounts.

Break it into:

1. Document collection
2. Identity check
3. Address check
4. Name matching
5. Risk screening
6. Missing-item handling
7. Maker-checker review
8. Compliance approval
9. Record retention

For each step state the responsible role and human approval point.

Banking use: Complaint workflows, KYC processes, SOP creation.



15. Meta-Prompting

Ask the AI to create or improve the prompt you need.

Best used when: Use when you know the business task but are unsure how to write the prompt.

Prompt builder

Improve

Start faster

Build a branch MIS prompt

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Help me write a prompt.

INPUT:

I need to summarize a branch MIS report.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask the AI to create or improve the prompt you need.

Why this example is better:

The AI designs the prompt framework, not just the final answer.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Create a reusable copy-paste prompt for summarizing a branch MIS report.

The prompt must include:

- Role
- Task
- Input-data placeholder
- Output format
- Length limit
- Privacy rule
- 'Do not guess' rule
- Human-review instruction

Also explain in 3 bullets why each section is useful.

Banking use: Creating reusable prompts for reports, complaints, and document Q&A.



15. Meta-Prompting

Ask the AI to create or improve the prompt you need.

Best used when: Use when you know the business task but are unsure how to write the prompt.

Prompt builder

Improve

Start faster

Improve a weak prompt

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Make my prompt better.

INPUT:

'Summarize this customer issue.'

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Ask the AI to create or improve the prompt you need.

Why this example is better:

It converts a vague instruction into a reusable professional prompt.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Improve the weak prompt below for banking use.

Add:

- Appropriate role
- Customer and case context
- Required output fields
- Privacy rule
- Missing-information rule
- Human approval rule
- Input placeholder

Weak prompt:

'Summarize this customer issue.'

Return:

1. Improved copy-paste prompt
2. Brief explanation of improvements

Banking use: Creating reusable prompts for reports, complaints, and document Q&A.



16. ReAct (Reason + Act)

Use a visible cycle: understand the need, check a source, answer, and review.

Best used when: Use for document-based tasks where the answer must be grounded in a policy or SOP.

Source check

Action cycle

Evidence

Policy-based answer

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Answer from this policy.

INPUT:

What is the maximum time for complaint acknowledgement?

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Use a visible cycle: understand the need, check a source, answer, and review.

Why this example is better:

The source-checking step keeps the answer grounded.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Use this process:

NEED:

Restate the policy question.

CHECK:

Search only the uploaded policy. Identify the relevant section.

ANSWER:

Provide a concise answer with the section reference.

REVIEW:

State what a human should verify before using the answer.

If the information is not found, say:

'Not available in the provided document.'

QUESTION:

What is the maximum time for complaint acknowledgement?

Banking use: Policy search, SOP Q&A, evidence-based answers.



16. ReAct (Reason + Act)

Use a visible cycle: understand the need, check a source, answer, and review.

Best used when: Use for document-based tasks where the answer must be grounded in a policy or SOP.

Source check

Action cycle

Evidence

Find escalation steps in an SOP

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Find escalation steps.

INPUT:

A high-value transfer complaint has been pending for 4 days.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Use a visible cycle: understand the need, check a source, answer, and review.

Why this example is better:

The process connects the case to evidence and a human control.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Follow this cycle:

QUESTION:

What escalation is required for the case?

SOURCE CHECK:

Use only the uploaded complaint-handling SOP.

ANSWER:

List the escalation steps in order and cite the relevant section.

CONTROL:

State what the supervisor must verify and approve.

CASE:

A high-value transfer complaint has been pending for 4 days.

Do not invent steps not found in the SOP.

Banking use: Policy search, SOP Q&A, evidence-based answers.



17. Thread-of-Thought

Maintain one connected structure across a long task or a series of prompts.

Best used when: Use for long reports, SOPs, training design, or projects developed in stages.

Long task

Continuity

Consistent flow

Connected training module design

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Create a training plan.

INPUT:

Topic: Prompt engineering for branch associates.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Maintain one connected structure across a long task or a series of prompts.

Why this example is better:

The common thread keeps a long deliverable consistent from start to finish.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Create a training plan and maintain the same connected structure for every module:

Objective -> Audience -> Banking scenario -> Concept -> Copy-paste prompt -> Live demo
-> Participant activity -> Risk control -> Takeaway

INPUT:

Topic: Prompt engineering for non-technical branch associates

Duration: 1 day

Participants: Customer service and operations staff

Keep terminology and formatting consistent across all modules.

Banking use: Training plans, SOPs, long reports, multi-step projects.



17. Thread-of-Thought

Maintain one connected structure across a long task or a series of prompts.

Best used when: Use for long reports, SOPs, training design, or projects developed in stages.

Long task

Continuity

Consistent flow

Connected SOP writing

[BEFORE - TOO VAGUE]

Create a long SOP.

INPUT:
SOP for duplicate debit complaints.

WHAT THIS TECHNIQUE CHANGES

Maintain one connected structure across a long task or a series of prompts.

Why this example is better:
A single narrative structure prevents disconnected sections.

[COPY-PASTE PROMPT]

Write an SOP for duplicate debit complaints using one connected flow:

Purpose -> Scope -> Definitions -> Inputs -> Roles -> Process steps -> Exceptions -> Escalation -> Approvals -> Customer communication -> Closure -> Audit record

Requirements:

- Keep terms consistent throughout
- Number every step
- Identify human approval points
- Do not invent regulatory requirements

INPUT:

The SOP is for branch and contact-centre associates handling duplicate debit complaints.

Banking use: Training plans, SOPs, long reports, multi-step projects.



Prompt Formula Cheat Sheet

A reusable structure for almost any workplace prompt.

ROLE

Who should the AI act as?

Example: Banking compliance reviewer

TASK

What should it do?

Example: Review a customer email

CONTEXT

What background matters?

Example: Refund is under verification

INPUT

CONSTRAINTS

OUTPUT

[COPY-PASTE MASTER TEMPLATE]

Act as a [ROLE].

TASK: [WHAT YOU WANT THE AI TO DO]

CONTEXT: [BACKGROUND INFORMATION]

INPUT: [PASTE SAMPLE OR APPROVED DATA]

RULES: [PRIVACY, TONE, LENGTH, RESTRICTIONS]

OUTPUT: [BULLETS / TABLE / EMAIL / SUMMARY]

If information is missing, write "Not provided." Mark items requiring human review.



Prompt Quality Checklist

Before submitting the prompt

- Task is clear
- Audience is identified
- Context is sufficient
- Input is included
- Output format is defined
- Length and tone are specified
- Sensitive data is removed
- Human review is mentioned

Before using the AI response

- Facts and amounts are correct
- All requested fields are covered
- Assumptions are clearly marked
- Tone suits the audience
- No sensitive information is exposed
- Policy alignment is checked
- Promises are properly qualified
- Responsible person has reviewed it



Common Prompting Mistakes

Weak patterns, why they fail, and how to improve them.

Too vague

Weak: Summarize this.

Improve: Add purpose, audience, format, and length.

Missing input

Weak: Analyze the complaint.

Improve: Paste the sample complaint or case details.

No output format

Weak: Review the report.

Improve: Ask for bullets, a table, an email, or fixed fields.

Too many tasks

Weak: One prompt asks for analysis, policy, email, and approval.

Improve: Split into numbered stages.

Inviting guesses

Weak: Tell me why this happened.

Improve: Use only provided data; mark missing facts.

Unsafe data sharing

Weak: Real account numbers, OTPs, or IDs are pasted.

Improve: Mask data and use approved tools only.

Blind trust

Weak: AI output is copied directly to a customer.

Improve: Verify facts, policy, tone, and approval.

Overpromising

Weak: Confirm the refund will arrive today.

Improve: Use qualified wording until verification is complete.



Prompt Improvement Framework

Use four simple stages: Draft, Diagnose, Add, and Test.

1 DRAFT

Write the basic request

Example: Summarize this complaint.

2 DIAGNOSE

Identify what is missing

Example: No input, audience, format, limits, or safety rule.

3 ADD

Add useful instructions

Example: Include context, output fields, constraints, and sample input.

4 TEST

Review and refine

Example: Check accuracy, missing details, tone, and privacy.

Improved example

Act as a branch service associate. Summarize the complaint below in 5 bullets: issue, customer impact, urgency, missing information, and next action. Use only the supplied data. Do not promise a refund. Mark any decision requiring human approval.

INPUT: Customer reports a duplicate RM 350 debit after a card purchase.



Responsible AI for Banking Associates

Use AI as an assistant, not as the final authority.

Protect privacy

Never paste real names, full account numbers, card data, PINs, OTPs, passwords, or confidential records into an unapproved tool.

Verify important outputs

Check names, dates, amounts, policy references, calculations, and customer-facing claims.

Watch for bias

Review language and recommendations for unfair assumptions about customers or groups.

Keep an audit trail

Retain the approved prompt, source, reviewer, and final version when the process requires it.

Use approved tools

Follow organizational policy on which AI systems and data classifications are allowed.

Avoid unsupported decisions

AI may support KYC, fraud, complaint, or loan review, but authorized humans must decide.

Be transparent

State when content is AI-assisted if required by organizational policy.

Escalate uncertainty

When evidence is missing or the case is high risk, stop and seek a qualified reviewer.